

C887

MA, Mathematics Education (5-9) Teacher Performance Assessment

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A teacher planning a four-week ratio unit in a school with a new STEM wing notes that 30% of the class are English learners and many students help at family businesses on weekends. The school's mascot is a hawk. Which use of this information best fits the contextual-factors component?

- A.** Plan vocabulary supports for ratio language and use pricing and inventory contexts from small businesses in problems.
- B.** Lower the unit goals because many students are English learners.
- C.** List the percentages in a table and move on to writing goals.
- D.** Feature the hawk mascot in every word problem.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

For a unit on two-step equations, a teacher whose room just got a new document camera drafts goals. Which is best stated as a learning goal?

- A.** Students will understand equations.
- B.** Students will use the document camera to present solutions.
- C.** Students will complete workbook pages 45-60.
- D.** Students will solve two-step linear equations with rational coefficients and justify each step.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A draft goal reads "Students will watch three videos about slope and take notes." What is the main flaw?

- A.** Goals should be aligned to standards only after the unit is taught.
- B.** It describes an activity rather than a measurable learning outcome.
- C.** Taking notes is observable, so the goal is acceptable.
- D.** Three videos is too many for one goal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A teacher's pre-assessment on proportional relationships has 10 problems on unit rates and graphing ratios. The post-assessment, given on the school's Chromebooks, has 10 problems on percent change and simple interest. What is the main problem?

- A. Changing to Chromebooks makes the scores invalid.
- B. Ten items are too few for either assessment.
- C. The post-test should always be harder than the pre-test to show growth.
- D. The two assessments measure different goals, so growth cannot be judged.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A pre-assessment shows 6 of 24 students have mastered unit rates, 12 show partial understanding, and 6 show none. The class meets in a portable classroom behind the gym. Which plan best uses these results?

- A. Start everyone from the beginning with the same lessons.
- B. Form flexible groups: extension tasks for the 6 who mastered it and targeted instruction for the other 18 at their level.
- C. Have the 6 advanced students tutor others for the entire unit instead of learning new content.
- D. Skip unit rates for the whole class because some students mastered them.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

Midway through a slope unit, an exit ticket shows 70% of students compute run over rise. The pacing guide, kept in a blue spiral binder, says to begin y-intercept tomorrow. What is the best decision?

- A. Repeat yesterday's lecture exactly, more slowly.
- B. Drop slope from the post-assessment since students struggled.
- C. Begin y-intercept as the pacing guide says.
- D. Reteach slope with a new approach, such as counting rise and run on graphed staircases, check again, and record the evidence and reason for the change.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher changed tomorrow's lesson and added small-group work for five students. For the instructional decision-making section, what must the write-up include?

- A.** A list of materials used in the small group.
- B.** A copy of the original lesson plan only.
- C.** The student evidence that prompted the change, what was changed, and why it should help.
- D.** A statement that the plan was followed exactly as written.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

In a class of 25 that recently got a new smartboard, the pre-assessment average was 40% and the post average was 76%. The 8 English learners averaged 30% before and 54% after. Which analysis is accurate?

- A.** The class gained 36 points and the English learner subgroup gained 24, so the subgroup needs follow-up.
- B.** The class gained 36 points, so every student met the goal.
- C.** The subgroup gained 54 points, more than the class.
- D.** Subgroup results cannot be analyzed because the smartboard was new.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

One student scored 12 out of 20 on the pre-assessment and 18 out of 20 on the post-assessment. What is the student's percentage-point gain?

- A.** 50 points
- B.** 30 points
- C.** 6 points
- D.** 90 points

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

Reflecting on an integer unit taught in a room that was repainted over break, a teacher finds 88% mastery on adding integers and 52% on multiplying integers. Which statement best meets the reflection component?

- A. The unit succeeded because the two goals averaged 70%.
- B. Students did not study for the multiplication items, so there is little I could change.
- C. Multiplication was least successful (52%); I spent less time on models for sign rules, so next time I will add number-line and pattern work and seek coaching on modeling.
- D. Fresh paint fumes likely lowered scores on the second goal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A student with an IEP for reading processing is in a unit on proportional word problems; the classroom has flexible seating and a class pet. Which change is an appropriate accommodation?

- A. Provide the problems read aloud or with text-to-speech while keeping the same proportional-reasoning goal.
- B. Replace the proportion problems with single-digit arithmetic.
- C. Seat the student next to the class pet to reduce stress.
- D. Give no changes, since every student must be treated identically.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which change is a modification rather than an accommodation?

- A. Giving extended time on the post-assessment.
- B. Providing a graphic organizer for setting up proportions.
- C. Assessing only one-step ratio problems while the class is assessed on multi-step problems.
- D. Reading the items aloud.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A teacher planning a four-week ratio unit ~~in a school with a new STEM wing~~ notes that 30% of the class are English learners and many students help at family businesses on weekends. ~~The school's mascot is a hawk.~~ Which use of this information best fits the contextual-factors component?

Target word: turning context into instructional implications **Decides:** The component asks what the factors mean for teaching.

A	Correct	Each factor is tied to a specific planning decision.
B	Confusion set	Confuses language support with lowered expectations.
C	Dropped element	Drops the implications, which are the point of the component.
D	Camouflage	Uses a detail that has no bearing on learner needs.

2. Answer D Concept 2

For a unit on two-step equations, a teacher ~~whose room just got a new document camera~~ drafts goals. Which is best stated as a learning goal?

Target word: measurable outcome **Decides:** An observable student performance tied to the standard.

A	Dropped element	"Understand" is not observable; the measurable performance is missing.
B	Camouflage	Built around the new device, not the math goal.
C	Confusion set	An activity, not a learning outcome.
D	Correct	States what students will do, at a measurable level.

3. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

A draft goal reads "Students will watch three videos about slope and take notes." What is the main flaw?

Target word: why a goal fails **Decides:** It names an activity, not what students will be able to do.

A	Inverted operation	Alignment comes first; goals guide planning.
B	Correct	A goal names the skill students will show, such as finding slope from two points.
C	Adjacent category	Note-taking is a behavior, not the math learning the unit targets.
D	Wrong stem number	The count is not the problem.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A teacher's pre-assessment on proportional relationships has 10 problems on unit rates and graphing ratios. The post-assessment, ~~given on the school's Chromebooks~~, has 10 problems on percent change and simple interest. What is the main problem?

Target word: assessment alignment **Decides:** The two tests measure different content.

A	Camouflage	Delivery mode is minor next to measuring different content.
B	Wrong stem number	Length is not the core flaw; alignment is.
C	Absolute language	Comparable difficulty, not harder, allows fair comparison.
D	Correct	Pre and post must target the same goals at comparable difficulty.

5. Answer B Concept 4

A pre-assessment shows 6 of 24 students have mastered unit rates, 12 show partial understanding, and 6 show none. ~~The class meets in a portable classroom behind the gym.~~ Which plan best uses these results?

Target word: design using pre-assessment data **Decides:** Three distinct readiness levels.

A	Dropped element	Ignores the pre-assessment data.
B	Correct	Grouping follows the data and can change as students progress.
C	Adjacent category	Peer tutoring has a place, but this denies the 6 their own growth.
D	Absolute language	Only a quarter of the class showed mastery.

6. Answer D Concept 5

Midway through a slope unit, an exit ticket shows 70% of students compute run over rise. The pacing guide, ~~kept in a blue spiral binder,~~ says to begin y-intercept tomorrow. What is the best decision?

Target word: responding to formative evidence **Decides:** Most students share one error that later content depends on.

A	Confusion set	Reteaching means a different approach, not the same one again.
B	Inverted operation	Changes the measure instead of the teaching.
C	Dropped element	Ignores the formative data.
D	Correct	Adjusts based on evidence, changes the method, and documents it.

7. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A teacher changed tomorrow's lesson and added small-group work for five students. For the instructional decision-making section, what must the write-up include?

Target word: what documentation must show **Decides:** The component asks for evidence, the change, and its rationale.

A	Adjacent category	Materials are a detail, not the decision and its reason.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out the evidence and the change.
C	Correct	Ties the decision to data and reasoning.
D	Inverted operation	The section is about departures from the plan.

8. Answer A Concept 6

In a class of 25 ~~that recently got a new smartboard,~~ the pre-assessment average was 40% and the post average was 76%. The 8 English learners averaged 30% before and 54% after. Which analysis is accurate?

Target word: class vs. subgroup gains **Decides:** Gains are post minus pre, in percentage points.

A	Correct	$76 - 40 = 36$; $54 - 30 = 24$.
B	Absolute language	A class average hides individual results.
C	Wrong stem number	Reports the post score as the gain.
D	Camouflage	Equipment age does not block analysis.

9. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

One student scored 12 out of 20 on the pre-assessment and 18 out of 20 on the post-assessment. What is the student's percentage-point gain?

Target word: individual gain in points **Decides:** 60% to 90%.

A	Confusion set	50% is the relative increase ($6 \div 12$), not a percentage-point gain.
B	Correct	$90\% - 60\% = 30$ percentage points.
C	Dropped element	Raw-score difference without converting to percent.
D	Wrong stem number	The post score, not the gain.

10. Answer C Concept 7

Reflecting on an integer unit ~~taught in a room that was repainted over break~~, a teacher finds 88% mastery on adding integers and 52% on multiplying integers. Which statement best meets the reflection component?

Target word: evidence-based reflection **Decides:** Reflection must use goal-level data, causes, and next steps.

A	Dropped element	Averaging hides the weak goal.
B	Inverted operation	Shifts responsibility to students instead of examining instruction.
C	Correct	Data, a plausible instructional cause, and specific next steps.
D	Camouflage	Blames an irrelevant detail; the first goal was taught in the same room.

11. Answer A Concept 8

A student with an IEP for reading processing is in a unit on proportional word problems; ~~the classroom has flexible seating and a class pet~~. Which change is an appropriate accommodation?

Target word: access without lowering the goal **Decides:** The need is reading, not the math.

A	Correct	Removes the reading barrier; the math goal is unchanged.
B	Confusion set	That is a modification; it changes the goal.
C	Camouflage	Does not address the reading need.
D	Absolute language	An IEP requires the listed supports.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

Which change is a modification rather than an accommodation?

Target word: spot the change to the goal **Decides:** A modification alters what is learned or assessed.

A	Confusion set	Changes timing, not the goal: an accommodation.
B	Adjacent category	A scaffold that supports the same goal.
C	Correct	The learning target itself is reduced.
D	Confusion set	Changes access, not content: an accommodation.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	4	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	4	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Contextual factors drive planning	Describe community, class, and student factors and state what each means for instruction and assessment.	Listing demographics with no stated implication.	“How should the teacher use this information?”
2	Learning goals are measurable outcomes	Goals are significant, standards-aligned statements of what students will be able to do, not activities the class will complete.	Writing an activity or a vague verb (understand, learn) as a goal.	A list of draft goals: look for the observable student performance.
3	Pre- and post-assessment alignment	Pre- and post-assessments measure the same goals at comparable difficulty so growth can be attributed to instruction.	Pre- and post-tests that cover different content.	Two assessments described side by side.
4	Pre-assessment data shape the design	Use pre-assessment results to group, sequence, and differentiate instruction before the unit starts.	Teaching the same plan to everyone regardless of what students already know.	A breakdown of how many students showed mastery, partial, or none.
5	Instructional decision making	Adjust mid-unit when formative evidence shows a gap, change the approach, and document the evidence and the rationale.	Following the pacing guide regardless, or repeating the same lesson unchanged.	An exit ticket or check that reveals a common error.
6	Analysis of student learning	Report growth for the whole class, a subgroup, and individuals, usually as percentage-point gains from pre to post.	Reporting a post score as the gain, or treating a class average as proof every student met the goal.	Pre and post averages for a class and a subgroup.
7	Evidence-based reflection	Name the most and least successful goals with data, give plausible instructional causes, and set specific next steps and growth goals.	Blaming students or giving a vague overall judgment.	Goal-by-goal mastery rates and a request for the best reflection.
8	Accommodation vs. modification	Accommodations change how students access or show learning while keeping the goal; modifications change the goal itself.	Lowering the goal and calling it an accommodation.	An identified need (IEP, 504, language) and a proposed change.

Course scope (public description): MA, Mathematics Education (5-9) Teacher Performance Assessment contains a comprehensive, original, research based curriculum unit designed to meet an identified educational need. It provides direct evidence of the candidate’s ability to design and implement a multi-week, standards-based unit of instruction, assess student learning, and then reflect on the learning process. The WGU Teacher Performance Assessment requires students to plan and teach a multi-week standards-based instructional unit consisting of seven components: 1) contextual factors, 2) learning goals, 3) assessment, 4) design for instruction, 5) instructional decision making, 6) analysis of student learning, and 7) self-evaluation and reflection.